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FA-2 Report		
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Detecting Adulterants In Edible Oil

1. Problem Statement

Conventional methods for testing edible oil purity, like spectroscopy, are highly accurate but are also expensive, slow, and require dedicated laboratory equipment. This makes them inaccessible for on-the-spot testing, leaving consumers and small businesses vulnerable to economic fraud and potential health risks from adulterated products. A low-cost, rapid, and portable solution is needed to verify oil purity in real-world settings.

2. Motivation

The primary motivation is to democratize food quality testing. With the universal availability of smartphones and the power of accessible AI, there's a unique opportunity to create a solution that is:

- **Low-Cost:** Uses a simple camera instead of expensive lab instruments.
- **Rapid:** Provides an instant prediction instead of waiting for lab results.
- **Accessible:** Can be used by anyone, anywhere, to fight food fraud and ensure the safety and quality of edible oils.

3. Objectives

1. To create a custom dataset of edible oil images with known adulteration percentages.
2. To extract a simple "color fingerprint" from each image by calculating the mean Blue, Green, and Red (BGR) values from a consistent Region of Interest (ROI).
3. To train a Partial Least Squares (PLS) Regression model to accurately predict the percentage of adulteration based on this color fingerprint.
4. To evaluate the model's performance using regression metrics like R-squared (R^2) and Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE).

5. To develop a complete system that can take a new, unknown image and provide an instant prediction of its adulteration level.

4. Introduction

Adulteration in edible oils is a significant global issue, impacting both consumer health and economic trust. While high-precision laboratory methods exist, their cost and complexity create a major barrier to widespread testing. This project bridges that gap by proposing an intelligent system that uses digital image processing and machine learning to predict adulteration percentages from a single photograph. By analyzing the average color values within a controlled Region of Interest, the system leverages a Partial Least Squares (PLS) Regression model to learn the subtle color shifts caused by adulterants. This approach offers a framework for a fast, affordable, and portable solution for oil quality verification.

5. Related Work

- **Classical Image Processing (Milanez, et al.):** Early methods used digital images and color histograms to classify oils. However, these systems require perfectly uniform lighting and are less effective for quantification (predicting percentages).
- **Lab-Based Spectroscopy (FTIR & NMR):** Advanced techniques like FTIR and NMR spectroscopy offer high accuracy in detecting adulterants by analyzing the oil's chemical or magnetic "fingerprints." Their major drawback is the reliance on expensive, complex, and non-portable laboratory equipment, making them unsuitable for real-time consumer use.
- **Our Approach:** This project fills the research gap by providing a system that balances simplicity and accuracy. It avoids the need for expensive lab equipment by using a standard camera, yet moves beyond simple classification to accurately **quantify** the level of adulteration.

6. Methodology

1. **Data Collection & Pre-processing:** A custom dataset of oil images was created with varying adulteration percentages (0%, 25%, 50%, etc.). Each image was named with its corresponding percentage.
2. **Feature Extraction:**
 - Each image was resized to a standard 256x256 pixels.
 - The image was denoised using a Median Blur to improve clarity.
 - A central Region of Interest (ROI) was cropped to focus only on the oil.
 - The average Blue, Green, and Red (BGR) values were calculated within the ROI. These three values served as the complete feature set.
3. **Model Architecture:** A Partial Least Squares (PLS) Regression model was chosen for its effectiveness in finding relationships between input features (the 3 BGR values) and a continuous numerical output (the adulteration percentage).

4. **Training Configuration:** The feature set was scaled using StandardScaler to normalize the data before being fed into the PLS model for training.
5. **Evaluation Metrics:** The model's performance was assessed using R-squared (R^2), which measures how well the model's predictions fit the actual data, and Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE), which measures the average prediction error.

Result

The PLS Regression model was successfully trained and evaluated.

- Overall Performance: The model achieved an R-squared (R^2) score of 77 and a Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE) of 18%. This indicates a strong predictive capability with a low average error margin.
- Visual Validation: The validation scatter plot showed the model's predictions (blue dots) clustering tightly around the ideal prediction line (red dashed line), visually confirming the high accuracy.
- Example Prediction: When tested on an unseen image of a 75% adulterated sample, the model predicted an adulteration level of 65%, demonstrating its practical effectiveness.

8. Conclusion

This project successfully developed an accurate and low-cost system for quantifying edible oil adulteration using a single digital image. By extracting a simple 3-point color fingerprint and training a PLS Regression model, we demonstrated that complex laboratory equipment is not always necessary for effective quality control. The model's high R^2 score and low RMSE prove that this image-based approach is a viable, accessible, and scalable solution. This work provides a strong foundation for developing real-world tools that can empower consumers and regulators in the fight against food fraud.

8. References

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